

Slide 1

Psychology and Human Behavior

Week 7 Wednesday — From diagnosis to a strategy that can be evaluated

NRES 315: Human Dimensions of Fish and Wildlife Management

Last updated: 2025-09-26

1 / 17

Slide 2

Monday gave us a diagnosis

Cognition, conation, affect. Person and situation. The specificity principle.

Today those become **frameworks** — the tools that turn a diagnosis into a strategy someone could fund and evaluate.

Source: Chapter 8, 8B-4

2 / 17

Slide 3

Today's question

What has to be true before a person performs a specific conservation behavior?

Source: Chapter 8, 8B-3

3 / 17

Slide 4

What you should be able to do

By the end of today, you should be able to:

- define a target behavior using **TACT**;
- apply the **reasoned action approach** – attitudes, perceived norms, perceived behavioral control;
- explain **collective action** and why a perceived norm changes what an individual does; and
- use **affect, motivation, and satisfaction** to explain a behavior the other frameworks miss.

Source: Chapter 8, 98.4.2–84.5

4 / 17

Slide 5

Define the behavior first

You cannot manage, measure, or evaluate a behavior you have not specified.

Source: Chapter 8, 98.4.3

5 / 17

Slide 6

TACT

Letter	Question	Weak	Strong
Target	What or whom?	"the environment"	live wells, bilge, and drain plug
Action	Do what, exactly?	"be responsible"	drain them
Context	Where, under what conditions?	"in general"	before leaving the north ramp
Time	When, how often, for how long?	"someday"	every trip, 2027 open-water season

"Boaters should care more about invasive species" fails all four. It cannot be observed, so it cannot be managed.

Source: Chapter 8, 98.4.3 and Box 8.1

6 / 17

Slide 7

The reasoned action approach

Behavioral **intention** is the most immediate predictor of behavior. Three things shape it:

- **Attitudes** – the person's own evaluation of the behavior.
- **Perceived norms** – the social pressure to perform or avoid it.
- **Perceived behavioral control** (self-efficacy) – belief in one's ability to carry it out successfully.

Source: Chapter 6, 98-4.3

7 / 17

Slide 8

Which lever is actually broken?

Attitude is fine, norm is fine, control is low → make the behavior easier, teach the skill, remove the time cost.

Attitude is fine, control is fine, norm is low → make others' behavior visible; recruit the groups people belong to.

Attitude is the problem → this is the rarest case in conservation, and the one most campaigns assume.

Source: Chapter 6, 98-4.3

8 / 17

Slide 9

Collective action

Some behaviors only make sense if others are doing them too.

Source: Chapter 6, 98-4.2

9 / 17

Slide 10

Individual factors and collective factors

The collective interest model holds that behavior is influenced by **individual factors** and **collective factors** together.

In the Montana bear-attractant work (Box 8.4):

- Different attractant-securing behaviors were associated with **different** suites of individual factors.
- **Collective factors were influential across the board.**
- Landowners who believed their neighbors were securing attractants, and expected them to keep doing so, were **30% to 100% more likely** to secure their own.

Source: Chapter 8, Box 8.4

10 / 17

Slide 11

Why this changes the intervention

If a person's behavior depends on what they believe others are doing, then a message about the harm of the problem is aimed at the wrong variable.

A perceived norm can be wrong. People routinely underestimate how many others are complying — and act on the underestimate.

Source: Chapter 8, 8E.4.2

11 / 17

Slide 12

Affect: emotions are not decoration

Emotions influence perception, judgment, memory, and behavior. They are psychological **and** physiological responses to events, situations, or stimuli.

- Seeing a robin at a feeder, or a raccoon at a trash can, can evoke anything from appreciation and awe to fear or disgust.
- In a deer-management study, emotions influenced the **acceptability of management options**.

Source: Chapter 8, 8E.4.4

12 / 17

Slide 13

Motivation and satisfaction

Motivation is why people act. Satisfaction is what they get out of it.
Decker and Connelly's three orientations:

- **Affiliative** – social interaction and bonding.
- **Achievement** – reaching a performance goal.
- **Appreciative** – peace, belonging, stress reduction.

Source: Chapter 8, §§4.3

13 / 17

Slide 14

Self-determination theory

Motivation is driven by three basic psychological needs:

- **Autonomy** – feeling in control of one's own actions.
- **Competence** – feeling effective in an environment.
- **Relatedness** – connection with others.

A program that tells people what to do, implies they are doing it wrong, and isolates them, undercuts all three at once.

Source: Chapter 8, §§4.3

14 / 17

Slide 15

Pair rehearsal: match the lever

With a partner, name the framework and the lever you would pull:

"There's a line of eight boats and a guy in a hurry behind me. I'm not holding that up for ten minutes."

"On the tournament circuit everybody decons. You'd get talked about if you didn't."

"Every sign out here is written like we did something wrong."

Source: Chapter 8, §§4.2–§4.4

15 / 17

Slide 16

Friday

Read the **Week 07 Case Brief: The Thornapple Lake Decontamination Problem** before class. All case facts are in it; bring the concepts from Chapter 8 and this week's class work.

A \$180,000 campaign changed nothing — because **92% of boaters already agreed** invasive mussels are harmful, before and after.

Source: Chapter 8, 98A-8.4.3

16 / 17

Slide 17

Close

A strategy that cannot name its target behavior, the lever it is pulling, and the indicator that would show it working is not a strategy. It is a hope.

Source: Chapter 8, 98.5

17 / 17
